STARTER KIT · NOVEMBER 2026

Everything you need to start cleaning

Llama COMMERCIAL

This is the kit for your first contracts: enough for two cleaners on regular commercial cleans, with floor and carpet machines added when the work comes in. Prices are UK retailer prices checked in November 2026 and include VAT unless marked. Lines marked **budget** are estimates to plan with, not quotes.

1. Day-one kit for regular cleaning (two cleaners)

Item	What to buy	Qty	Each	Total
Commercial vacuum	Numatic NRV240 (the commercial "Henry")	2	£145	£290
Flat mop system	Numatic ECO-Matic SRK16: two 17L buckets (red and blue handles) and a flat mop press	2	£61	£122
Flat mop heads	Microfibre, in red, blue and green for colour coding (budget)	12	£4	£48
Wet floor signs	A-frame "Caution wet floor"	4	£7	£29
Colour-coded cloths	Packs of 50, one pack each in red, blue, green and yellow	4	£5	£20
Microfibre cloths	Premium 10-packs in the four colours	4	£8.39	£34
Chemicals	5L concentrates: multi-surface, washroom cleaner and descaler, disinfectant, glass, neutral floor cleaner, kitchen degreaser (budget)	6	£20	£120
Bottles and caddies	Labelled trigger bottles in the four colours, two carry caddies (budget)	1 set	£30	£30
PPE	Nitrile gloves (boxes), safety glasses, kneeling pads (budget)	1 set	£40	£40
Uniforms	Bottle-green polos with embroidered logo, three per cleaner (budget)	6	£18	£108
Day-one total				**£841**

Optional: a Numatic ECO-Matic EM2 trolley (about £202 including twist mop, bucket and wringer) for a site that lets you store kit on the premises.

2. Floors and carpets: buy, hire or subcontract

Machine	Use	Buy	Hire	Start with
Carpet extractor (Numatic CT370)	Hot-water extraction of carpets and upholstery	£365 to £371	–	Buy. One or two carpet jobs pay for it.
Rotary floor machine (Numatic Hurricane HFM1530 or Victor Contractor 400)	Scrubbing, stripping, polishing hard floors	about £1,005	£48 a day, £80 a week + VAT	Hire for each job until you have regular floor work.
Floor stripper (5L)	Removing old polish before resealing	£19 to £20	–	Buy per job. 5L covers about 300 m².
Pressure washer (Kärcher HD 5/12 C Plus)	Car park decks, ramps, stairwells	about £649	local hire	Hire or subcontract the first car park jobs.

Rule of thumb: buy what you'll use every week (vacuums, mops, cloths, the carpet extractor). Hire what you'll use once a month (the rotary machine, the pressure washer). Price the hire into the quote.

3. Colour code for cloths, mops and buckets

- Red: toilets, urinals, washroom floors
- Blue: general areas
- Green: kitchens and food areas
- Yellow: clinical areas, washroom sinks

Label every bottle, keep red kit in its own bag, and never take a red cloth into a kitchen. Show new staff on their first shift.

4. Set-up checklist

Company and money

- [ ] Run a UK IPO trademark search for "Llama Commercial" (class 37, cleaning services)
- [ ] Register Llama Commercial Ltd at Companies House
- [ ] Open a business bank account
- [ ] Register as an employer with HMRC (PAYE) before the first payday
- [ ] Set up payroll and pension auto-enrolment
- [ ] Pay the ICO data protection fee
- [ ] Choose accounting software and set up the invoice template
- [ ] Check llamacommercial.co.uk is free and register it

Insurance and safety

- [ ] Employers' liability insurance (at least £5m, a legal requirement once you employ staff)
- [ ] Public liability insurance, sized to what your clients ask for
- [ ] COSHH assessment for every chemical, with its safety data sheet in a folder
- [ ] A risk assessment and method statement for each new site

- [ ] Accident book and first aid kit in the van or kit bag
- [ ] Machine training before anyone uses a rotary floor machine

People

- [ ] Right-to-work check for every cleaner before their first shift
- [ ] DBS checks to the level each site needs (schools may ask for more)
- [ ] Written contracts and the staff handbook from the launch pack
- [ ] Basic training: colour code, COSHH, safe lifting, using the machines
- [ ] Consider BICSc Licence to Practice for lead cleaners (assessment slot £50)
- [ ] Uniforms ordered with the logo

Selling

- [ ] Business mobile number and WhatsApp Business set up
- [ ] Website live with your real number and email
- [ ] Google Business Profile with the social avatar and real photos
- [ ] Business cards and flyers printed (print files in the brand pack)
- [ ] Quote calculator and negotiation desk bookmarked on your phone
- [ ] Site specification, quote and invoice templates ready
- [ ] Key holding log and alarm code record
- [ ] A list of the first 50 buildings to visit: offices, schools, churches, shops near Hackney

5. First month plan

Week	Do this
1	Company, bank, insurance, HMRC. Order the day-one kit and uniforms.
2	Website and Google profile live. Print cards and flyers. Hire your first cleaner, with right-to-work and DBS checks.
3	Walk the 50-building list: drop the letter and flyer, ask for the person who manages the building, book site visits.
4	Site visits, written specifications and quotes. Start the first contract with you working alongside the cleaner.

No drama. Just Llama.